SabaiApply — Complete Strategy & Product Document

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1. What is SabaiApply

> *"One platform for Thai university admissions — for students to apply, for universities to manage."*

SabaiApply is a full admission management platform for Thailand. It solves two problems:

For Students	For Universities
One profile, apply to any university	Dashboard to manage all applications
No more 5 different portals	No more spreadsheets and manual checking
Track all applications in one place	Auto-screen eligibility
Get notified about every deadline	Score, interview, publish results from one system
AI chatbot for guidance	Real-time confirmation tracking

Core Features

1. **AI Chatbot Assistant —** answers admission questions 24/7 in Thai & English
2. **Notifications —** Line/Email/SMS for deadlines, results, confirmations
3. **One Application for All Unis —** fill profile once, apply everywhere
4. **University Info Hub —** housing, fees, scholarships, all in one place
5. **Portfolio Builder —** create on SabaiApply OR import from iFolio/TCASFolio
6. **Faculty Dashboard —** full admission workflow management

2. ICP (Ideal Customer Profile)

ICP Framework (from zeroto1accelerator.com)

An ICP must pass all 5 criteria:

1. **Painful problem NOW** — visible this quarter, tied to money/risk
2. **Controls a budget** — can approve spend without committees
3. **Can buy fast** — 30 days or less from first call to payment
4. **Can pay a high price** — you can name 20-30 real companies
5. **You can reach them** — repeatedly, through network or outreach

Who IS Our ICP

Heads of Admissions at Thai private universities who are currently struggling with manually processing Portfolio and Quota round applications while losing students to public universities in Round 3, and they can approve ฿___/month within 30 days to capture and lock in more students before centralized matching pulls them away.

Target list: Assumption, Bangkok University, Rangsit, Sripatum, Dhurakij Pundit, SPU (~70 private universities in Thailand)

Criteria	Private Universities	Pass?
Pain NOW	Declining enrollment, losing students in Round 3	Yes
Controls budget	Admissions head can approve operational spend	Yes
Can buy fast	No government procurement process	Yes
Can pay high price	Already spend on recruitment (fairs, ads, agencies)	Yes
Reachable	~70 in Thailand, most in Bangkok	Yes

Who is NOT Our ICP

Candidate	Why Not
Students/Parents	Don't control budgets, users not customers
High School Counselors	No budget authority
Ministry of Education	6-18 month procurement, committees, politics
KMITL / Public Universities	Government procurement = slow, fails "buy fast"

KMITL's Role

KMITL is our **research lab and case study**, not our customer. We use KMITL for:

- Learning the real admissions pain from the inside
- Credibility: "We researched this at KMITL first"
- Network: intros to private university admissions heads
- Proof of concept: demonstrate SabaiApply using KMITL data

ICP Validation Scorecard

Score each university interview (0-2 per question):

Question	0	1	2
Do they have pain?	"It's fine"	"It's annoying"	"It's a nightmare"
Is it urgent?	"Someday"	"This year"	"This cycle"
Budget authority?	"President decides"	"I can recommend"	"I can approve"
Buy in 30 days?	"Long process"	"Maybe 2-3 months"	"If it works, yes"
Would they pay?	"Only if free"	"Depends on price"	"How much?"
Reach again?	"Don't contact me"	"Send a proposal"	"Let's follow up"

8-12 = Strong ICP | 4-7 = Weak | 0-3 = Not ICP. Need 3 out of 5 universities scoring 8+.

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3. Market Context: TCAS, iFolio, TCASFolio

TCAS (Thai University Central Admission System)

Run by CUPT. 4 rounds:

Round	Name	Type	Who Controls
1	Portfolio	Decentralized	Each university/faculty
2	Quota	Decentralized	Each university/faculty
3	Admission	Centralized	mytcas.com
4	Direct Admission	Decentralized	Each university

SabaiApply focuses on Rounds 1, 2, 4 + International — the decentralized rounds where each university runs their own chaotic process. Round 3 is already handled by mytcas.com.

iFolio (KMITL's System)

- Built by KMITL, for KMITL only
- URL: ifolio.kmitl.ac.th
- Students upload portfolios for Round 1
- Just a file upload system — no review, scoring, or management tools

TCASFolio (National System by CUPT)

- Launched October 2025 for TCAS69
- URL: folio.mytcas.com
- Free, standardized portfolio builder
- Generates PDF + shareable links

- Up to 40 portfolios per student
- **Optional, not mandatory** — universities can accept it, their own system, or freestyle PDFs

Why Multiple Systems Exist

Reason	Details
Autonomy	Universities don't want CUPT controlling their admissions
TCASFolio is new	Universities already built their own systems before it launched
Different faculty needs	Engineering wants coding projects, Architecture wants design portfolios — generic tools can't serve both
Sunk cost	KMITL paid to build iFolio, won't throw it away
Trust issues	Universities worry about data ownership, uptime, and losing control
TCASFolio is optional	Added a third option instead of replacing existing ones — more fragmentation, not less

The Current Student Experience

```
Student applying to 5 universities in Round 1:

KMITL         → Use iFolio (KMITL's own system)
Chulalongkorn → Use TCASFolio OR freestyle PDF
Mahidol       → Use their own portal
Rangsit       → Use TCASFolio OR freestyle
Assumption    → Use their own Google Form

= 5 accounts, 5 portals, same info entered 5 times,
  portfolio reformatted 5 times, 5 separate payments,
  track results on 5 different websites
```

The Gap Nobody is Filling

TCASFolio and iFolio fight over portfolio CREATION. Neither helps with what comes after:

- How faculties REVIEW portfolios (still Excel)
- How faculties SCORE portfolios (still manual)
- How faculties SCHEDULE interviews (still phone/email)
- How faculties PUBLISH results (still Facebook)
- How faculties TRACK confirmations (still spreadsheets)
- How students APPLY to multiple universities (still 5 portals)
- How students TRACK status across applications (still check 5 websites)

SabaiApply fills this entire gap.

4. KMITL Meeting Findings

Meeting with KMITL IT Team — April 2026

Key Findings

Finding	What It Means
Every faculty handles applications separately	Fragmentation is REAL — even within one university
Each faculty has different deadlines	No standardization — confirms SabaiApply needs per-faculty config
Round 1 (Portfolio) is the hardest part	Validates our focus on Round 1 first
They use iFolio for portfolio submissions	iFolio is just upload — everything after is manual
IT team asked "how can SabaiApply handle that?"	Buying signal — they're imagining it working, not dismissing it

Critical Insight

Before the meeting: We thought the problem was "too many application forms"
After the meeting: The real problem is "faculty drowns in portfolios they have to manually review, filter, and manage"

Follow-Up Actions

1. Ask KMITL IT to connect us with 1-2 faculty admissions coordinators
2. Ask specific questions: "After portfolios come through iFolio, what exactly does faculty do next?"
3. Get numbers: How many applications per faculty? How many staff? How many hours?
4. Start contacting private universities this week

5. SabaiApply's Positioning

iFolio vs TCASFolio vs SabaiApply

	iFolio	TCASFolio	SabaiApply
What it is	Portfolio upload tool	Portfolio creation tool	Full admission management platform
Built by	KMITL only	CUPT (national)	Independent
Works for	KMITL only	Any university (optional)	Any university that joins
Student: create portfolio	Yes	Yes	Yes + import from iFolio/TCASFolio
Student: apply to multiple unis	No	No	Yes
Student: track applications	No	No	Yes
Student: notifications	No	No	Yes (Line/Email/SMS)
Faculty: review dashboard	No	No	Yes
Faculty: auto-screen eligibility	No	No	Yes
Faculty: scoring system	No	No	Yes
Faculty: interview scheduling	No	No	Yes
Faculty: result publishing	No	No	Yes

Faculty: confirmation tracking	No	No	Yes
AI chatbot	No	No	Yes
Online payment	No	No	Yes
Multi-round support	Round 1 only	Round 1 only	Rounds 1, 2, 4 + International

The Analogy

```
iFolio / TCASFolio = A MAILBOX
└ Student puts portfolio in
└ Faculty takes it out
└ Everything after = manual

SabaiApply = The Entire POST OFFICE
└ Student puts portfolio in (or imports from iFolio/TCASFolio)
└ Auto-sorted to correct faculty
└ Auto-checked for eligibility
└ Faculty reviews in organized dashboard
└ Scoring built in
└ Interviews scheduled automatically
└ Results published with one click
└ Confirmations tracked live
└ Everything after submission = handled
```

Portfolio Strategy: Both Options

Option A: Build Our Own Portfolio Creator
Students can create portfolios directly on SabaiApply with a better experience than iFolio/TCASFolio — no file size headaches, no crashes, better UI.

Option B: Import from Existing Systems
Students who already made portfolios on iFolio or TCASFolio can import/link them into SabaiApply.

We do BOTH. Student's choice. No lock-in.

The Pitch

> *"iFolio and TCASFolio help students package their work. SabaiApply helps universities actually open it, evaluate it, and make decisions. Your students still use whatever portfolio tool they want. We handle everything after that — and everything before it."*

Real Competition

Our real competition is NOT iFolio or TCASFolio. It's:

Actual Competitor	What We Replace
Excel / Google Sheets	Application tracking, scoring, ranking
Email / Phone calls	Student communication, interview scheduling
Facebook pages	Result announcements
Manual checking	Eligibility verification
Multiple university portals	Fragmented application process

6. Complete Feature Set

Student Features

Profile & Documents (Fill Once)

- Personal info (name, DOB, nationality, ID/passport, address, phone, Line)
- Education history (school, GPA, subjects, graduation year)
- Test scores (GAT/PAT, TGAT/TPAT, A-Level, O-NET, SAT, IELTS/TOEFL)
- Document vault (upload once, use everywhere): transcript, ID copy, photo
- Activities, awards, certificates, volunteer work
- Projects & research

Portfolio Builder (Option A)

- Create portfolio directly on SabaiApply
- Categorized sections: academics, projects, awards, activities, statements
- No file size headaches — proper upload handling
- Auto-format to each university's requirements
- Export as PDF or shareable link

Portfolio Import (Option B)

- Import from TCASFolio via shareable link
- Import from iFolio
- Upload freestyle PDF
- All formats accepted — student chooses

Browse & Match

- Browse all universities and programs
- Eligibility checker: "Show me programs I qualify for"
- Side-by-side comparison (fees, seats, acceptance rate, deadlines)

- Filter by: field, location, language, fees, scholarships
- Save favorites

Apply

- One-click apply — profile auto-fills, faculty-specific questions auto-load
- Eligibility pre-checked before submission (no wasted applications)
- Online payment (PromptPay, credit card, TrueMoney)
- Can apply to multiple universities from one dashboard

Track & Notifications

- Real-time application status tracker across all universities
- Line/Email/SMS notifications for: deadlines, results, confirmations, interview schedules
- TCAS confirmation window reminders (critical — often only 24-48 hours)
- Waitlist position updates

AI Chatbot

- 24/7 in Thai and English
- "Am I eligible for KMITL Software Engineering with GPA 3.2?"
- "What documents do I need for Round 1?"
- "Can I apply with Duolingo instead of IELTS?"
- Score prediction for Round 3 (based on historical cutoffs)

Info Hub

- University profiles: programs, fees, campus info
- Housing/dormitory options with prices
- Scholarship finder: input scores → see what you qualify for
- Visa guidance (international students)

University/Faculty Features

Faculty Setup (One-Time Config)

- Set programs, seats, deadlines per faculty

- Set eligibility requirements (GPA, scores, subjects)
- Set required documents
- Add custom questions (faculty-specific)
- Define scoring rubric with weights
- Manage admin accounts per faculty

Application Dashboard

- View all applications, auto-filtered by eligibility (green/yellow/red)
- Auto-sorted by program
- Search, filter, sort by any field
- View student profile, documents, portfolio, responses on one page
- Bulk actions (shortlist, reject, export)

Scoring System

- Custom rubric per program (loaded automatically)
- Academic record auto-scored from GPA
- Manual scoring for portfolio, projects, activities
- Weighted total auto-calculated
- Multiple reviewers supported
- Auto-ranking by total score

Interview Scheduling

- Faculty sets available slots (dates, times, duration)
- Students self-book their slot
- Automatic reminders sent
- No-show detection → auto-notify waitlisted students
- Interview scores added to total

Results & Confirmations

- One-click publish results — all students notified instantly
- Accepted, waitlisted, not accepted — each gets appropriate message

- Real-time confirmation tracking dashboard
- Waitlist auto-advance when someone withdraws
- Export reports in TCAS format for CUPT submission

Central Admin View

- University-wide overview across all faculties
- Total applications, acceptance rates, confirmation rates
- Compare faculty performance
- Export university-wide reports

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7. Round 1 Portfolio — Full Workflow

Round 1 is our primary focus. Here's the complete current process vs SabaiApply, step by step.

Phase 1: Announcement (October)

Now (Manual)	SabaiApply
Faculty writes announcement document (PDF/webpage)	Faculty fills a config form (30 minutes)
Send to central admissions to publish	Published instantly on SabaiApply
Students hunt across websites for requirements	Students see all requirements on one page
Different faculties, different formats, different locations	Unified, searchable, filterable
Time: 2-3 days per faculty	**Time: 30 minutes per faculty**

Phase 2: Student Application (November - December)

Now (Per University)	SabaiApply
Find announcement (Google, Facebook, PDF)	Browse & search on SabaiApply
Figure out eligibility manually	System tells you instantly: qualified or not
Create portfolio (TCASFolio? iFolio? Freestyle?)	Build on SabaiApply OR import from anywhere
Create account on university portal	Already have SabaiApply account
Enter personal info AGAIN	Auto-filled from profile
Upload documents AGAIN	Already uploaded
Pay via bank transfer / 7-11 / varies	Online payment (PromptPay/card)

Repeat for every university	Apply to 5 unis in 10 minutes

Phase 3: Faculty Review (January) — THE HARDEST PART

Now (Manual)	SabaiApply
Download/access 1,500 portfolios in various formats	All in one dashboard, uniform layout
Check eligibility manually (GPA, scores, docs) — 50-125 hours	Auto-checked. Only eligible applications shown. **0 hours.**
Sort by program manually in Excel	Auto-sorted. Each faculty sees only their programs.
Score on paper/Excel, calculate weighted totals	Score in dashboard, auto-calculated
Track review progress informally	Progress bar: "142/287 reviewed"

Phase 4: Interview Scheduling

Now (Manual)	SabaiApply
Call/email 80 students one by one	System sends notifications instantly
Back-and-forth to find times	Students self-book from available slots
Track confirmations in spreadsheet	Real-time dashboard
Student no-show → manually call waitlist	Auto-advance waitlist, auto-notify
3-5 days of scheduling work	**0 days — fully automated**

Phase 5: Decision & Results

Now (Manual)	SabaiApply
Review final rankings in Excel	Auto-ranked dashboard with cutoff line

Post results on website/Facebook	One-click publish
Students check multiple channels	Instant notification via Line/Email/SMS
Students don't know waitlist position	Live waitlist position shown
5-10 hours	**5 minutes**

Phase 6: Confirmation Tracking

Now (Manual)	SabaiApply
Manually track who confirmed on TCAS	Real-time dashboard
Student withdraws → manually contact waitlist	Auto-notify next on waitlist
Compile report for CUPT manually	One-click export in TCAS format
Panic during 48-hour confirmation window	Everything tracked live, reminders sent
10-15 hours	**0 hours**

Total Time Saved Per Faculty Per Round

Task	Before	SabaiApply	Saved
Announce requirements	2-3 days	30 min	2+ days
Check eligibility	50-125 hours	0 (automated)	50-125 hours
Sort by program	5-10 hours	0 (automated)	5-10 hours
Review & score portfolios	80-150 hours	80-150 hours	0 (still manual, but organized)
Schedule interviews	15-20 hours	0 (self-service)	15-20 hours
Communicate results	5-10 hours	5 minutes	5-10 hours
Track confirmations	10-15 hours	0 (automated)	10-15 hours
TOTAL	**170-330 hours**	**80-150 hours**	**~50% reduction**

Professors spend time reading portfolios and judging quality — that stays manual. SabaiApply eliminates EVERYTHING around it.

8. All Rounds — SabaiApply's Approach

Round 1: Portfolio (Oct-Feb) — FULL MANAGEMENT

- Student creates/imports portfolio, applies through SabaiApply
- Faculty gets full dashboard: review, score, interview, results, confirmations
- **This is our primary product. Build this first.**

Round 2: Quota (Feb-Apr) — FULL MANAGEMENT

- Score-based (TGAT/TPAT/A-Level) — easier than Round 1
- Students already have profiles from Round 1, just update scores
- Faculty dashboard auto-ranks by weighted score formula
- Faculty mostly just reviews and confirms — minimal manual work

Round 3: Admission (May) — ADVISOR MODE ONLY

- Fully centralized on mytcas.com — SabaiApply does NOT process applications
- SabaiApply provides: score predictions based on historical cutoffs, strategy advice via AI chatbot, deadline notifications, status tracking alongside other rounds
- **Free feature** — keeps students on the platform

Round 4: Direct Admission (May-Jun) — MARKETPLACE

- Universities with unfilled seats list availability on SabaiApply
- Students who didn't get in earlier rounds browse open spots
- One-click apply (profile already complete)
- Fast-track everything — universities desperate to fill, students desperate to find
- **Highest urgency = highest willingness to pay**

International Admission (Year-round) — FULL MANAGEMENT

- Currently worst experience: manual PDFs, bank transfers, 5+ websites

- SabaiApply: unified profile, online payment, auto-format per university
- Post-acceptance: visa guidance, housing booking, orientation info
- **Premium pricing — highest value per application**

Revenue Per Round

Round	Role	Revenue Model
Round 1	Full application + faculty dashboard	Per-application fee from university
Round 2	Full application + auto-ranking	Per-application fee from university
Round 3	Advisor + notifications only	Free (student retention)
Round 4	Marketplace (seats ↔ students)	Per-filled-seat fee from university
International	Full application + support	Higher per-application fee

Full Year Timeline

```
AUG-SEP:  Students create profiles, upload documents
          AI chatbot helps build portfolio strategy

OCT-DEC:  #### ROUND 1 PORTFOLIO ####
          Apply to multiple universities
          Faculty dashboards active — reviewing portfolios
          Interview scheduling

JAN:      Round 1 results & confirmations
          Notifications: "Confirm by Jan 20 or lose your spot"

FEB-MAR:  #### ROUND 2 QUOTA ####
          Score-based applications
          Auto-ranking on faculty dashboards

APR:      Round 2 results & confirmations

MAY:      #### ROUND 3 ADMISSION ####
          SabaiApply = advisor mode
          Score predictions, cutoff comparisons
          Deadline notifications
```

```
MAY-JUN:  #### ROUND 4 DIRECT ####
          Live marketplace: open seats ↔ available students
          Fastest application flow

YEAR-ROUND: International admissions
            AI chatbot support
            University info & comparison
```

9. University Dashboard System

One System, Many Views

SabaiApply builds **ONE dashboard**. The data changes based on who logs in.

```
Login: engineering@kmitl.ac.th
→ Sees: Only Engineering applications, deadlines, requirements

Login: architecture@kmitl.ac.th
→ Sees: Only Architecture applications, deadlines, requirements

Login: business@kmitl.ac.th
→ Sees: Only Business applications, deadlines, requirements

Login: admin@kmitl.ac.th (central admissions)
→ Sees: Everything across all faculties, university-wide stats
```

Scale Advantage

Scenario	Dashboards Built	Faculty Configs
KMITL (12 faculties)	1	12
+ Rangsit (10 faculties)	Still 1	+10
+ Assumption (8 faculties)	Still 1	+8
10 universities, 100 faculties	Still 1	100

Build the dashboard ONCE. Scales to infinite faculties and universities through config.

This is standard SaaS architecture — like Shopify doesn't build a new store for each merchant.

Faculty Setup Flow (One-Time, 30 Minutes)

```
Faculty Setup Form:
```

```
1. Faculty name: [Faculty of Engineering]
2. Programs offered: [+ Add Program]
   - Software Engineering | 50 seats | Min GPA 3.0
   - Computer Engineering | 40 seats | Min GPA 2.75

3. Required documents:
   [x] Transcript
   [x] Portfolio
   [ ] Recommendation letter
   [x] ID copy

4. Custom questions: [+ Add Question]
   - "Describe a project you built" (500 words)

5. Deadlines:
   Round 1: Dec 15, 2026
   Round 2: Mar 1, 2027

6. Scoring rubric:
   Academic record: 30% (auto-scored from GPA)
   Projects: 25% (manual review)
   Awards: 20% (manual review)
   Activities: 15% (manual review)
   Statement: 10% (manual review)

7. Admin accounts:
   - somchai@eng.kmitl.ac.th (reviewer)
   - napat@eng.kmitl.ac.th (admin)

[Save & Publish]
```

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10. How SabaiApply Reduces University Workload

Problem 1: Incomplete Applications

Now	SabaiApply
30-40% of applications come incomplete	0% incomplete — system enforces all requirements
Staff emails students, waits, follows up	Students cannot submit until everything is uploaded
Hundreds of back-and-forth messages	Zero chasing

Problem 2: Eligibility Screening

Now	SabaiApply
Staff manually checks GPA, scores, subjects for each applicant	Auto-filtered: green (qualified), yellow (borderline), red (doesn't qualify)
5,000 applications = weeks of checking	Staff reviews only borderline cases
50-125 hours	0 hours

Problem 3: Sorting by Program

Now	SabaiApply
Staff manually sorts: "This one wants Software Eng, this one wants Architecture..."	Auto-routed. Each faculty sees only their applicants.
Faculties ask "where's my list?" and admissions scrambles	Each department head logs in and sees their candidates instantly

Problem 4: Interview Scheduling

Now	SabaiApply
Call/email each shortlisted student individually	Students self-book from available slots
Track on spreadsheets	Real-time schedule dashboard
No-show? Manually contact waitlist	Auto-advance, auto-notify

Problem 5: Result Communication

Now	SabaiApply
Manually send acceptance/rejection emails or post on website	One-click publish, all students notified instantly
"When are results coming?" messages flood in	Zero — everyone gets notified
Students don't know waitlist position	Live waitlist tracking

Problem 6: Confirmation Tracking

Now	SabaiApply
Manually track who confirmed on TCAS within 48-hour window	Real-time dashboard
Mistakes during confirmation = serious problems	Export-ready reports matching TCAS format
Waitlist manually advanced	Auto-advance when someone withdraws

The One-Slide Pitch

Without SabaiApply	With SabaiApply
Staff reviews 5,000 raw applications	Staff reviews 500 borderline cases

30-40% applications incomplete	0% incomplete
Manual sorting by program	Auto-routed to each faculty
Interview scheduling via email/phone	Self-service booking
Manual result notifications	One-click publish + auto-notify
Spreadsheet confirmation tracking	Real-time dashboard
Weeks of manual work per round	Days

11. Revenue Model

Revenue Stream	Who Pays	Model
Application processing (Round 1, 2, 4)	University	Per-application fee OR monthly subscription
Round 4 marketplace (seat filling)	University	Per-filled-seat fee (premium — universities are desperate)
International admissions	University	Higher per-application fee
Featured listing / priority placement	University	Monthly fee for visibility boost
Round 3 advisor	Nobody	Free — drives student adoption
Student application fee	Student	Small fee per application (optional, later)

Pricing to validate: Ask private university admissions heads "What would you pay per application processed through our system?" during ICP interviews.

12. Tech Stack

Layer	Technology	Cost
Frontend	Next.js on Vercel	Free tier
Backend / Database / Auth	Supabase	Free tier
Domain	sabaiapply.com (Namecheap)	Purchased
Email notifications	Resend	Free tier

Line notifications	Line Messaging API	Free
AI Chatbot	Claude API or OpenAI	Pay per use
Payments	Omise (Thai payment gateway)	Per transaction
DNS / CDN	Cloudflare	Free
Professional email	Zoho Mail	Free

Total starting cost: ~฿0 (domain already bought, everything else on free tiers)

13. Priority Action List

PRIORITY 1: DO THIS WEEK (Critical)

1.1 — Landing page on sabaiapply.com

Use Carrd.co or Framer (free). One page: what SabaiApply does, contact form. 30 minutes of work.

1.2 — Set up professional email

team@sabaiapply.com or hello@sabaiapply.com via Zoho Mail (free). Looks 10x better than pitching from Gmail.

1.3 — Write down everything from KMITL meeting

Exact quotes, names, numbers, findings. While it's fresh.

1.4 — Send thank-you to KMITL IT team

Email or Line. Ask: "Can you connect us with 1-2 faculty admissions coordinators?"

1.5 — List 5 private universities to contact

Assumption, Bangkok University, Rangsit, Sripatum, Dhurakij Pundit. Find admissions head contact info.

PRIORITY 2: DO NEXT 2 WEEKS (ICP Validation)

2.1 — Interview 5 private university admissions offices

Pain interviews, not sales pitches. Use KMITL intros + cold outreach + campus visits.

Questions to ask:

- "How do you handle Round 1 applications?"
- "What percentage come incomplete?"
- "How many staff-hours does processing take?"
- "How do you schedule interviews?"

- "How do you track confirmations?"
- "What tools do you currently use?" (expect: Excel)
- "If a platform could solve this, would that be worth paying for?"

2.2 — Score each interview using ICP scorecard

Need 3 out of 5 scoring 8+ to confirm ICP.

2.3 — Get TCAS Round 4 data

Find which private universities had the most unfilled seats last cycle. Those are your hottest leads.

PRIORITY 3: DO IN WEEKS 3-4 (Pre-Sell)

3.1 — Create one-page proposal

Google Doc, not code. Show: the problem, SabaiApply's solution, mockups, proposed pricing.

3.2 — Build mockups in Figma

Student application flow + faculty dashboard. Even hand-drawn is fine.

3.3 — Go back to 2-3 most interested universities

Show mockups. Ask: "If we build this, would you sign up for a paid pilot?"

3.4 — Get letters of intent or verbal commitments

Even better: get a paid pilot agreement before writing a single line of code.

PRIORITY 4: DO IN WEEKS 5-8 (Build MVP)

4.1 — Build MVP (ONLY after at least 1-2 universities said "yes, we'd pay")

MVP features (bare minimum):

- **Student side:** Create profile, upload documents, browse programs, check eligibility, apply, track status
- **Faculty side:** Set up programs & requirements, add custom questions, review dashboard, filter/sort/search, accept/reject, export data

> **Skip for MVP:** AI chatbot, housing/scholarship database, payment processing, TCAS integration, mobile app, Round 3 advisor, Round 4 marketplace

> **4.2 — Build portfolio creation tool**
>
> Simple portfolio builder + import from TCASFolio/iFolio. Both options.

PRIORITY 5: DO IN WEEKS 9-12 (Pilot)

> **5.1 — Onboard 1-2 universities**
>
> Help them set up faculty configs. Hold their hand through the first cycle.

> **5.2 — Get real students applying through SabaiApply**

> **5.3 — Collect feedback, iterate**

> **5.4 — Start charging**

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14. Phase-by-Phase Roadmap

Phase 1: Validate (Weeks 1-2) ← CURRENT PHASE

Goal: Prove the pain is real and someone will pay.
Output: 5 interview scorecards. At least 3 scoring 8+.
Cost: ฿0
If nobody cares → pivot the idea. Better to know now than after 3 months of coding.

Phase 2: Pre-Sell (Weeks 3-4)

Goal: Get commitment before building.
Output: 1-2 letters of intent or paid pilot agreements.
Cost: ฿0 (Figma is free, Google Docs is free)
Key question: "If we build this, would you pay ฿___/month starting in [month]?"

Phase 3: Build MVP (Weeks 5-8)

Goal: Build only what was pre-sold, nothing more.
Output: Working platform with student application flow + faculty dashboard.
Cost: ฿0 (free tier everything)
Rule: No code until someone says "I'll pay for that."

Phase 4: Pilot (Weeks 9-12)

Goal: Real usage, real feedback, real revenue.
Output: 1-2 universities live, students applying, money coming in.
Focus: Round 1 Portfolio only. One round. Done well.

Phase 5: Expand (Month 4+)

Sequence of expansion:

1. Round 1 Portfolio — highest pain (validated by KMITL)
2. Round 4 Direct Admission — desperate buyers, easiest to sell
3. Round 2 Quota — natural extension, score-based (easier)
4. International Admissions — premium pricing
5. Round 3 Advisor — free, drives student adoption
6. AI Chatbot — added value
7. Housing/Scholarship database — info hub

What NOT To Do Right Now

Tempting	Why Not
Start coding the platform	Don't know what to build yet
Design a logo / brand	Nobody cares about logos
Build a mobile app	Way too early
Add features to a roadmap	Don't have users yet
Look for investors	Nothing to invest in yet
Build for students AND universities simultaneously	One ICP only
Build all 4 rounds at once	Round 1 first, prove it, then expand
Spend money on anything except the domain	Protect your cash

The Rule

No code until someone says "I'll pay for that."

No features until users ask for them.

No expansion until Round 1 works perfectly.

No assumptions until 5 real conversations validate them.

SabaiApply — CommonApp for Thailand

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